WORK WITH AI

Where AI Works Best

AI will take on almost anything you ask: writing, planning, summarizing, coding, drawing, researching, and more. But **can try** is not the same as **built for**, and AI is far better at some kinds of work than others.

We saw this firsthand building this course. AI coded every page and every interaction you'll see, and we give it a grade of **A+** for coding. It also wrote the first drafts of all lessons, but only earned a **C–**. It made points in the wrong order, added explanations that missed what we meant, and had no real feel for how a lesson should flow.

That gap is the whole lesson in one example. Writing software code is all about patterns, and AI is a pattern-making machine, so it aces that job. But writing strong lessons doesn't follow a set pattern, so AI can help, but it can't do the whole thing.

Aim that one ability at real work, and it becomes four distinct strengths.

AI is strongest when the job has one of four shapes.

🍀 Same meaning, new shape.

AI learns patterns, so it can take your input and recast it into something clearer, cleaner, or better structured. The meaning stays the same; only the shape changes.

EXAMPLES

- Coding help
- Reformatting messy data
- Translating between languages
- Turning an outline into prose

PATTERNED TRANSFORMATION

🎲 Ten versions in ten seconds.

AI builds each answer by predicting likely pieces, and there are usually many likely options. So it can give you several versions at once.

EXAMPLES

- Brainstorming angles
- "Give me 10 variations"
- Rewriting in a different tone
- First drafts of common documents

GENERATIVE VARIATION

🔍 Finds the signal in long documents.

AI can read long documents and see past the words on the page to what they actually mean. So it can shrink long documents down to the core, or surface the one part you actually need.

EXAMPLES

- Summarizing a chapter
- Extracting key points
- Finding the relevant section in a long document
- Answering questions from supplied material

SEMANTIC COMPRESSION AND RETRIEVAL

🧠 Reasons through what you give it.

AI can hold a lot of information at once. Give it the facts, the constraints, and the goal, and it can work through them toward an answer.

EXAMPLES

- Planning a project
- Debugging code
- Comparing options
- Critiquing a draft

STRUCTURED REASONING AND SYNTHESIS

WHY THIS WORKS: VAST EXPOSURE

Training gave AI exposure to more examples than any human could read in a lifetime: code, essays, explanations, emails, arguments, stories, documents, and conversations. That's why it's fluent with common formats. It has seen many versions of "this kind of thing" before.

But exposure has a limit. AI is often good at the common version of a task, not necessarily the true, current, personal, safest, or best version. That's why your judgment still matters.